

INSTITUTIONAL RESEARCH STYLE GUIDE

HARRISON ROLFES | SENIOR RESEARCH ANALYST | PRIVATE COMPANY
COVERAGE

A pre-flight checklist for private market analysis. Ensure every report bridges the gap between quantitative data and strategic foresight. Institutional readers read to allocate capital and assess risk, not for pleasure. Keep it sharp, authoritative, and data-driven.

☐ 1. The Apex Principle (Punchline First)

Start with the answer. AI builds up to a conclusion; human experts deliver the verdict first. Your opening sentence must be the single most important takeaway, stating exactly what the market is mispricing or what the data proves.

☐ 2. High Signal-to-Noise (Eradicate Adjectives)

Adjectives project uncertainty. Let the hard data create the emphasis for you. If you catch yourself writing "massive," "significant," or "drastic," delete the adjective and insert the metric.

AVOID: "Compute costs are seeing massive growth and significantly impact margins."

DO: "Compute CapEx now consumes 65 cents of every top-line dollar, breaking early-stage SaaS unit economics."

☐ 3. Enforce Rhythmic Asymmetry

AI writes like a metronome with perfectly balanced sentence lengths. To sound human and authoritative, aggressively vary your cadence. Follow a complex, multi-clause explanation of a valuation framework with a sharp, punchy, declarative sentence. It projects confidence.

☐ 4. The "So What?" Imperative

Reporting states what happened; analysis states what it means. Never leave a data point hanging. Every metric must tie back directly to valuation multiples, exit timelines, capital efficiency, or risk underwriting.

CHECK: If you mention multiple contraction, immediately clarify if it signals a distressed buyout opportunity or a structural sector decline.

☐ 5. Eliminate "Throat-Clearing"

Never introduce what you are about to say. Dive straight into the analysis. Strip out all robotic transition filler and assume your reader is highly sophisticated.

BAN: "It is important to note," "Furthermore," "Delve," "Robust," "Paradigm shift."